

Samsung Galaxy A34 5G

Compelling mid-ranger with undeniable Samsung DNA

The Galaxy A34 looks like an excellent bang for the buck offer with upgrades such as a new design language, a faster refresh rate, a newer processor, and upgraded RAM. Does it manage to make a splash in this segment when compared to popular devices? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

There's a certain amount of care and attention to detail that's gone into making the Samsung Galaxy A34 5G that's rare to find in mid-range phones, save for perhaps, the Nothing Phone (1). The Samsung Galaxy A34 attempts to ape the design language of the company's flagship S23 series lineup. And, it is successful to quite an extent. Despite the plastic construction, at no point does the Galaxy A34 feel cheap – in fact, the in-hand feel is quite the opposite of cheap. The front of the phone, however, breaks the illusion of an uber premium phone due to two primary reasons – the dated U-shaped notch and the relatively thick chin bezel. What we couldn't overlook though, is the slow Optical In-Display Fingerprint sensor. While accurate, the fingerprint sensor does take its sweet time to unlock the device.

DISPLAY

The display has good clarity and viewing angles, and vibrant and punchy colours as well. However, the U-shaped notch does impact overall immersion. That aside, the A34's panel is the brightest we've tested in the mid-range segment. With Adaptive Brightness turned on, we recorded a whopping 1120 nits of peak brightness under sunlight. There will be no legibility issues in harsh sunlight. The display supports a 120 Hz refresh rate, but this is not adaptive, so it is fixed to either 60 Hz or 120 Hz according to the setting applied. All these are enough for us to recommend this to users who consume a lot of content.



PERFORMANCE

We pit the Samsung Galaxy A34 against the Nothing Phone (1), iQOO Neo 7, Pixel 6a, POCO X5 Pro (it's ₹5,000 cheaper), and the Redmi Note 12 Pro+ as they're all priced about the same. In AnTuTu, the A34 only managed to beat out the Note 12 Pro+. In Geek Bench 6 Single Core, the A34 had the best score. But, it lagged behind every score in the Multi-Core test except the Note 12 Pro+. We also ran PCMark Work, and the Galaxy A34 shined here. However, in GPU benchmarks, the Galaxy A34's scores were the lowest. You can play CoD: Mobile at 60 fps without too many frame drops with ease. Be sure to play such demanding games on Low or Medium graphics. In my opinion, the iQOO Neo 7 is the better choice for gamers. The A34's One UI is a decent software skin and generally less spammy than other at this price. However, if you want a clean software experience, the Pixel 6a is still the best – no doubt.

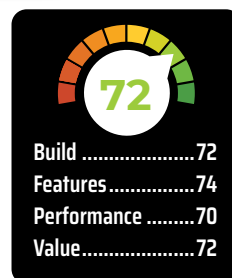
CAMERA

The Galaxy A34 5G's primary camera is capable of clicking detailed shots in daylight. It is surprisingly proficient at clicking detailed shots even in tricky

lighting, even in nighttime, with Night Mode on. The portrait images out of this phone also look fantastic with saturated colours that look social-media-ready. The edge detection is also great for the most part. Ultrawide shots look good. The dynamic range is decent, but the details in the shadows do get clipped. Low-light ultrawide shots have plenty of noise and grain. Macro shots are surprisingly decent. Selfies look mostly good, but they do get noisy in low light. Portrait selfies have fine edge detection, and the colours of human skin tones seem quite natural if you turn off Beauty Mode. Video is not great at this price point. Video footage is decent in daylight but without Ultra Steady mode, there's quite a lot of jitter.

BATTERY LIFE

We got 13 hours and 2 minutes of battery life in our 4K video loop test. While the battery life is not bad at all, it is not the best in the segment. The 25 W wired fast charging which tops up the phone from zero to full in over one and a half hours – this is laboriously slow in 2023.



VERDICT

Samsung Galaxy A34 sports a gorgeous, premium design and a bright Super AMOLED display. The design is, exudes a premium air that very few do at this price. The display, is simply the brightest we've ever tested at this price. However, there are some misses as well. What you get is dependable enough performance with enough panache to convince most users of its mettle, especially Samsung lovers.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 1080 | RAM: 8 GB | Internal storage: 128 GB, expandable up to 1 TB | Display: 6.6-inch FHD+ | Display type: Super AMOLED | Cameras (rear): 48 MP + 8 MP + 5 MP | Front camera: 13 MP | Video: Up to 4K at 30 fps | Battery: 5,000 mAh | OS: Android 13, One UI 5.1

CONTACT

Samsung | Phone: 1-800-5-726-7864 | Email: support.india@samsung.com | Website: <https://www.samsung.com/in/>